STRATIVA CONSULTING

CLIENT ENGAGEMENT & ETHICS MANUAL

Smart Strategies. Sustainable Growth.

Client Communication and Engagement Ethics SOP

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CONFIDENTIAL & PROPRIETARY — STRATIVA CONSULTING HEADQUARTERS

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1. COMPANY INFORMATION & DOCUMENT OVERVIEW

Strativa Consulting is a business consulting, startup development, branding, and digital marketing firm headquartered in Karachi, Pakistan. This Client Communication and Engagement Ethics Standard Operating Procedure (Document Reference: **STR-CLIENT-SOP-007**) establishes mandatory standards for ethical, professional, and transparent client communication across all stages of the advisory relationship.

2. PURPOSE OF THE POLICY

The purpose of this SOP is to ensure that Strativa Consulting communicates with potential and existing clients ethically, professionally, honestly, and consistently throughout the complete client life cycle. The policy establishes rigorous procedures for first contact, onboarding, needs assessment, proposals, quotations, ongoing project communication, complaint resolution, feedback collection, satisfaction monitoring, and offboarding.

> **CORE COMMITMENT TO TRANSPARENCY**
>
> Strativa Consulting places paramount importance on trust, accountability, confidentiality, realistic commitments, and long-term client relationships. All client interactions must reflect our core brand tagline: *Smart Strategies. Sustainable Growth.*

3. SCOPE AND APPLICABILITY

This SOP applies universally to all individuals operating on behalf of Strativa Consulting, including the Managing Director, business consultants, project managers, marketing strategists, client relationship managers, brand designers, digital specialists, interns, and authorized third-party representatives.

This policy governs all communication channels, including official email, telephone and video calls, in-person meetings at our Karachi office or client premises, approved messaging platforms (such as WhatsApp Business and Microsoft Teams), formal proposals, quotations, contracts, reports, and project management portals. It covers potential leads as well as active and former clients.

4. CLIENT COMMUNICATION PRINCIPLES

Every employee and consultant at Strativa Consulting must strictly uphold the following ten core principles in all client interactions:

- **Honesty and Transparency:** Provide truthful information regarding our capabilities, timelines, and pricing without misleading statements.
- **Professionalism and Courtesy:** Maintain polite, respectful, and dignified conduct in every verbal and written exchange.
- **Clear and Accurate Information:** Ensure project scopes, deliverables, and expectations are communicated without ambiguity.
- **Respect for Client Needs and Preferences:** Adapt communication styles and schedules to respect client time zones, communication channels, and cultural norms.
- **Confidentiality and Privacy:** Safeguard all client commercial data, financial records, and proprietary strategies with absolute discretion.
- **Realistic Promises and Commitments:** Avoid inflated claims or guaranteed business outcomes that cannot be objectively verified.
- **Timely Responses and Follow-Ups:** Acknowledge inquiries promptly and adhere strictly to agreed follow-up commitments.
- **Accountability for Mistakes:** Acknowledge operational or communication errors transparently and take prompt corrective action.
- **Fair Treatment and Non-Discrimination:** Serve all clients equitably regardless of business size, industry, or background.
- **Ethical Sales and Relationship Management:** Engage in consultative selling that prioritizes the client's genuine business needs over short-term sales volume.

5. FIRST CONTACT AND INITIAL CLIENT ENGAGEMENT

Approaching potential clients requires structured, respectful, and non-intrusive engagement.

1. **Research:** Review publicly available business information (company website, social media, registry records) to understand the prospect's operations.
2. **Needs Identification:** Identify potential strategic or marketing gaps without making unsupported assumptions about their internal operations.
3. **Introduction:** Introduce Strativa Consulting, highlighting relevant advisory services tailored to startups and growing businesses in Karachi.
4. **Polite Communication:** Use courteous, personalized messaging that respects the prospect's time.
5. **Permission to Consult:** Ask explicit permission before scheduling a detailed discovery discussion.
6. **Record Keeping:** Log prospect inquiries, questions, and agreed next steps in the corporate CRM.
7. **Respecting Declines:** Immediately respect any decision by a prospect not to proceed, terminating promotional outreach gracefully.

5.1 Sample Introductory Scripts

SAMPLE INTRODUCTORY EMAIL

Subject: Strategic Growth & Marketing Inquiry | Strativa Consulting & [Client Company Name]

Dear [Client Name],

I hope this email finds you well. I have been following [Client Company Name]'s recent developments in Karachi's retail sector and admire your brand's growth trajectory.

I am reaching out from Strativa Consulting. We specialize in partnering with growing businesses to streamline startup planning, brand positioning, and digital customer acquisition. Given your expansion goals, we would welcome the opportunity to share how our structured advisory frameworks can support your upcoming campaigns.

Would you be available for a brief 15-minute introductory call next week on Tuesday or Thursday at your convenience?

Best regards, [Your Name] | Business Strategy Consultant, Strativa Consulting

6. CLIENT ONBOARDING PROCEDURE

When a client decides to engage Strativa Consulting, a formal, transparent onboarding workflow must be initiated immediately to establish clear expectations.

- **Identity Verification:** Confirm the client's official business name, registration details, and official billing address.
- **Authorized Representative:** Identify the single designated decision-maker authorized to approve project scopes and invoices.
- **Objectives Alignment:** Document core client objectives, KPIs, and success criteria.
- **Scope Confirmation:** Review the agreed service deliverables, inclusions, and explicit exclusions.
- **Proposal & Quotation Approval:** Ensure the formal proposal and quotation have been signed or approved in writing.
- **Commercial Terms:** Document professional fees, payment milestones, invoicing schedules, and required client inputs.
- **Agreements & NDA:** Execute the professional services agreement and mutual Non-Disclosure Agreement (NDA).
- **Communication Channel:** Establish the primary communication contact and approved collaboration channels (e.g., dedicated project folder and email thread).
- **Meeting Cadence:** Schedule recurring project status check-ins (e.g., weekly 30-minute sync).
- **Project Record:** Create the official client file in the CRM and project management repository.
- **Welcome Message:** Send a formal welcome email outlining immediate next steps.

Mandatory Rule: Project work must not commence until formal agreement execution and advance payment receipt have been verified by management, except where preliminary scoping has been explicitly authorized in writing.

6.1 Client Onboarding Checklist

Onboarding Task / Milestone	Responsible Role	Status / Date Completed
Verify client legal identity and contact details	Client Relationship Manager	[ ] Completed: _____
Confirm authorized client decision-maker	Client Relationship Manager	[ ] Completed: _____
Finalize and sign Professional Services Agreement	Managing Director	[ ] Completed: _____
Execute Mutual Non-Disclosure Agreement (NDA)	Managing Director	[ ] Completed: _____
Confirm receipt of 50% advance project fee	Financial Planning Consultant	[ ] Completed: _____
Establish shared project folder & communication channels	Project Manager	[ ] Completed: _____
Send formal Welcome Email & project timeline	Client Relationship Manager	[ ] Completed: _____

7. CLIENT NEEDS ASSESSMENT

Consultants must thoroughly investigate and understand client requirements before proposing any commercial service package. Assessments must separate confirmed facts from assumptions, identify operational risks, and align expectations.

Illustrative Example: When supporting fictional clients such as **AZ Signature** (a Karachi-based women's fashion and clothing brand), consultants must assess seasonal inventory cycles, target demographic purchasing power, and digital marketing readiness before structuring brand positioning proposals.

7.1 Sample Needs-Assessment Questionnaire

STRATIVA CONSULTING — CLIENT NEEDS-ASSESSMENT QUESTIONNAIRE

1. Business Overview: What is your core product/service offering, and how long have you been operating in Karachi?

2. Primary Objectives: What are your top 2–3 strategic business goals for the next 6 to 12 months (e.g., launching a new product line, expanding online sales, refining brand positioning)?

3. Target Audience: Who is your ideal customer profile (demographics, purchasing behavior, geographic focus)?

4. Current Challenges: What major obstacles are currently hindering your growth or operational efficiency?

5. Budget & Timeline: What is your anticipated investment budget and target completion deadline for this project?

6. Success Metrics: How will you measure the success of this consulting engagement upon completion?

8. PROPOSALS, QUOTATIONS, PRICING, AND SCOPE OF WORK

Proposals and quotations must be precise, transparent, and binding upon formal approval.

- **Mandatory Inclusions:** Client name, project reference, identified needs, deliverables, scope inclusions/exclusions, timeline, client responsibilities, pricing in PKR, payment schedule, validity period (typically 30 days), revision limits, assumptions, dependencies, and change-request procedures.
- **Ethical Pricing Standards:** Prices must be explained clearly with zero hidden fees. All incidental expenses must be disclosed in advance. False discounts or fabricated urgency ("valid for 2 hours only") are strictly prohibited.

8.1 Sample Quotation Summary Table (Illustrative Planning Assumptions)

Service Package Reference	Core Deliverables & Scope Summary	Estimated Duration	Illustrative Price (PKR)
STR-PKG-01: Starter Consultation	One-time strategic consultation, business model review, and verbal advisory report.	1 Week	PKR 25,000
STR-PKG-02: Startup Planning	Comprehensive business plan, target-market overview, financial roadmap, and launch recommendations.	3 Weeks	PKR 90,000
STR-PKG-03: Brand Development	Brand positioning, core messaging framework, and basic visual identity guidelines.	3 Weeks	PKR 110,000

Note: Amounts shown above are illustrative planning assumptions for academic and startup modeling, not guaranteed fixed pricing.

9. RESPONSE-TIME SERVICE STANDARDS

To manage client expectations professionally, Strativa Consulting enforces internal response-time targets. *Note: These are proposed operational targets and internal service standards, not legally binding commercial warranties.*

Client Inquiry / Communication Type	Proposed Response Standard	Operational Guidelines
New Client Inquiries	Within 4 business hours	Acknowledge receipt and schedule discovery call.
Routine Client Emails	Within 1 business day	Provide substantive update or status ETA.
Client WhatsApp Messages	Within 2–4 working hours	During official working hours (Mon–Sat, 9 AM – 6 PM PKT).
Urgent Project Issues	Within 2 business hours	Escalate to Project Manager immediately.
Meeting Requests	Within 1 business day	Propose 2–3 suitable dates/times.
Proposals & Quotations	Within 3 business days	Following completed needs-assessment meeting.
Client Feedback on Work	Within 2 business days	Acknowledge receipt and set review timeline.
Complaints & Service Concerns	Within 1 business day	Immediate empathetic acknowledgment required.
Missed Client Calls	Within 2 business hours	Return call or send professional follow-up message.
After-Hours Messages	Next business morning	Staff are not expected to monitor off-hours channels.

Acknowledgment vs. Resolution: Acknowledging an inquiry confirms receipt. Complex technical or strategic matters require further investigation, and the client must be provided with an expected resolution timeframe.

10. CLIENT FOLLOW-UP SCHEDULE

Systematic follow-ups ensure active deals progress without appearing intrusive. Staff must respect client preferences and cease promotional follow-ups immediately if a client declines further contact.

- **First Follow-Up:** Approximately 2–3 business days after sending a proposal or quotation.
- **Second Follow-Up:** Approximately 5–7 business days later if no response has been received.
- **Final Follow-Up:** Approximately 10–14 business days after initial submission, offering a final courteous check-in before closing the lead file.

11. CLIENT MEETINGS AND MEETING MINUTES

All client meetings must be conducted with rigorous preparation, active listening, and formal documentation.

- **Preparation:** Review previous correspondence, proposals, and project notes prior to the call.
- **Conduct:** Maintain professional posture, encourage open client dialogue, and avoid making unverified commitments on the spot.
- **Documentation:** Circulate formal Minutes of Meetings (MoM) within 24 hours to record decisions, responsibilities, and deadlines.

11.1 Ready-to-Use Minutes of Meeting (MoM) Template

STRATIVA CONSULTING — CLIENT MEETING MINUTES (MoM)

Project Name / **Ref:** AZ Signature Brand Strategy | **Date:** 18 Nov 2026

Meeting Location / **Mode:** Karachi Office / Zoom **Time:** 11:00 AM PKT

Attendees: Ahmed Khan (Strativa), Sara Ahmed (AZ Signature)

Agenda: Review preliminary brand positioning concepts and social media rollout calendar.

Main Discussion Points: Client preferred minimalist aesthetic over vibrant color palettes. Agreed to integrate eastern heritage motifs into digital ads.

Decisions Made: Brand archetype approved as 'Contemporary Traditional Elegance'.

Action Items:

1. Revise brand mood board | **Responsible:** Brand Designer | **Deadline:** 22 Nov 2026
2. Finalize media budget draft | **Responsible:** Marketing Strategist | **Deadline:** 24 Nov 2026

Next Meeting Date: 25 Nov 2026, 11:00 AM PKT **Prepared By:** Project Manager

12. HONESTY IN SERVICE DESCRIPTIONS, TIMELINES, AND COMMITMENTS

Strativa Consulting maintains absolute integrity in representing its professional capabilities.

- **Accurate Representation:** Never exaggerate past project results or fabricate industry case studies.
- **Realistic Timelines:** Base project schedules on actual team capacity and deliverables review cycles.
- **Scope Changes:** If unforeseen delays or scope creep occur, notify the client promptly in writing, explaining revised timelines and resource impacts before proceeding.

Unethical / Prohibited Communication	Ethical / Compliant Communication
"We guarantee your boutique will achieve 300% sales growth in month one."	"Our digital marketing strategy is designed to optimize your customer acquisition funnel, though exact sales results depend on market conditions."
Hiding additional revisions fees until after the project draft is submitted.	Clearly outlining revision limits (e.g., 2 rounds) in the proposal and quoting transparent rates for additional rounds.

13. CLIENT CONFIDENTIALITY AND PRIVACY

Safeguarding client data is a fundamental ethical and professional obligation.

- **Scope of Protection:** Client contact details, financial statements, business plans, contracts, login credentials, and unpublished marketing materials must be treated as strictly confidential.
- **Access Control:** Share information strictly on a need-to-know basis within the authorized project team.
- **Secure Storage:** Utilize approved corporate cloud repositories with encrypted permissions. Never store client files on unapproved personal devices.
- **Public Discretion:** Never discuss confidential client matters in public spaces (e.g., restaurants, ride-sharing vehicles, public seminars).
- **Public Portfolio Use:** Obtain explicit written consent before featuring a client's brand name, logo, or project deliverables in public case studies or marketing portfolios.
- **Legal Context:** Adhere to professional standards of confidentiality and applicable data privacy norms in Pakistan. Formal contracts must incorporate binding confidentiality clauses.

14. PROFESSIONAL BOUNDARIES AND CONFLICT OF INTEREST

Consultants must maintain professional objectivity and avoid situations that compromise their advisory independence.

- **Personal Boundaries:** Maintain strictly professional relationships with clients, avoiding inappropriate personal involvement.
- **Gifts and Kickbacks:** Refuse any gifts, favors, or financial kickbacks exceeding nominal promotional value (approx. PKR 2,000) that could influence professional judgment.
- **Conflict Disclosure:** Immediately disclose any financial, personal, or commercial interest that creates a potential conflict of interest with an existing or prospective client.
- **Competing Clients:** Do not undertake advisory work for direct competitors in the same niche without full disclosure and mutual consent.
- **Management Review:** The Managing Director will review disclosed conflicts and determine whether mitigation or declination is required.

15. COMPLAINT HANDLING AND ESCALATION

Client grievances are handled through a structured, empathetic, and objective 9-step resolution process:

1. **Reception:** Receive the complaint politely, listening attentively without interruption or defensiveness.
2. **Acknowledgment:** Acknowledge receipt in writing within 1 business day and log the details in the Complaint Register.
3. **Triage:** Assess the core issue, urgency, and expected resolution parameters.
4. **Assignment:** Assign the complaint to an appropriate responsible team member (e.g., Project Manager).
5. **Investigation:** Review project records, emails, deliverables, and team notes objectively.
6. **Solution Formulation:** Develop a fair corrective proposal (e.g., scope revision, additional review round, or explanatory meeting).
7. **Management Approval:** Obtain approval from the Managing Director for any financial credits, refunds, or major scope adjustments.
8. **Communication:** Present the proposed resolution clearly to the client and secure agreement.
9. **Closure & Learning:** Document the resolution in the Complaint Register and conduct an internal review to prevent recurrence.

Escalation: Complaints involving severe data breaches, ethical concerns, unresolved financial disputes, or repeated service failures must be escalated immediately to the Managing Director.

15.1 Client Complaint Register Template

Complaint ID	Date Received	Client Name	Core Issue Summary	Assigned Owner	Status	Resolution Date
CMP-2027-01	14 Mar 2027	AZ Signature	Delay in social media content calendar delivery.	Project Manager	Resolved	16 Mar 2027

16. FEEDBACK COLLECTION AND CLIENT SATISFACTION TRACKING

Continuous improvement is driven by systematic client feedback collection across project milestones and upon engagement closure.

- **Milestone Reviews:** Brief feedback checks conducted at major deliverable sign-offs.
- **End-of-Project Survey:** Structured digital questionnaire measuring communication, quality, timeliness, value, and professionalism.
- **KPI Tracking:** Management reviews satisfaction scores monthly.

16.1 Key Performance Indicators (KPIs) & Formulas

KPI Name	Calculation Formula	Proposed Target
Client Satisfaction Score (CSAT)	(Sum of positive survey ratings ÷ Total survey responses) × 100	90%+
On-Time Deliverable Rate	(Deliverables completed on/before deadline ÷ Total deliverables) × 100	95%
Complaint Resolution Rate	(Complaints successfully resolved ÷ Total complaints logged) × 100	100%
Repeat Client / Referral Rate	(Clients returning or referring new business ÷ Total past clients) × 100	20%+

17. CLIENT OFFBOARDING AND ENGAGEMENT CLOSURE

Ending a client engagement professionally ensures long-term goodwill and positive referrals.

- **Written Confirmation:** Confirm project completion or formal contract closure in writing.
- **Deliverable Handover:** Provide all final approved files, reports, and brand assets via secure cloud transfer.
- **Financial Settlement:** Verify that all final invoices have been settled and accounts balanced.
- **System Access Revocation:** Securely revoke client system permissions and collaboration channel access.
- **Data Retention & Disposal:** Retain project archives in accordance with corporate data retention policies; securely dispose of temporary sensitive drafts.
- **Final Goodwill:** Express professional gratitude, request feedback survey completion, and establish future communication preferences.

18. ROLES AND RESPONSIBILITIES

Organizational Role	Core Client Communication & Engagement Responsibility
Managing Director / Founder	Approves major contracts, pricing policies, commercial agreements, executive escalation handling, and conflict mitigation.
Client Relationship Manager	Oversees onboarding, inquiry handling, routine correspondence, CRM updating, and satisfaction surveys.
Project Manager	Manages daily project communication, meeting scheduling, MoM distribution, and timeline tracking.
Business Strategy Consultant	Conducts needs assessments, discovery meetings, proposal scoping, and strategic advisory delivery.
Marketing & Digital Specialists	Execute client campaign deliverables, report performance metrics, and maintain technical communication standards.
Financial Planning Consultant	Manages invoicing schedules, payment verification, and financial milestone tracking.
All Staff Members	Adhere strictly to confidentiality, professional tone, response-time standards, and ethical guidelines.

19. RECORDS, MONITORING, AND POLICY COMPLIANCE

Strativa Consulting maintains organized digital records of all client interactions, needs assessments, proposals, signed agreements, meeting minutes, complaints, and feedback surveys in secure cloud repositories. Management conducts quarterly compliance audits to evaluate adherence and identify training needs.

20. POLICY VIOLATIONS AND CORRECTIVE ACTIONS

Violations of this client communication SOP (such as unauthorized commitments, confidentiality breaches, disrespectful communication, or misleading statements) are evaluated objectively based on severity, frequency, and intent. Corrective measures include:

- Informal coaching and communication retraining.
- Formal written warnings and supervision.
- Temporary suspension of direct client-facing responsibilities.
- Disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment or contract, for severe breaches.

21. IMPLEMENTATION AND REVIEW GOVERNANCE

This policy is introduced to all staff during onboarding orientation and reinforced through quarterly professional development workshops. Management reviews this document annually to incorporate evolving business needs and regulatory standards.

Version	Effective Date	Description of Changes	Prepared By	Approved By
1.0	1 Jan 2027	Initial Release - Final Academic & Operational SOP Draft	Management	Managing Director

22. APPENDICES: READY-TO-USE TEMPLATES & CHECKLISTS

Appendix A: Client Onboarding Checklist

(Refer to Section 6.1 for the complete onboarding checklist table).

Appendix B: Client Needs-Assessment Questionnaire

(Refer to Section 7.1 for the complete questionnaire box).

Appendix C: Sample Quotation Summary (Illustrative PKR Amounts)

(Refer to Section 8.1 for illustrative pricing tables). All figures are planning assumptions for academic projects.

Appendix D: Minutes of Meeting (MoM) Template

(Refer to Section 11.1 for the ready-to-use MoM template).

Appendix E: Client Follow-Up Message Examples

SAMPLE PROPOSAL FOLLOW-UP WHATSAPP / MESSAGE

"Dear [Client Name], I hope you're having a productive week. I'm following up on the brand development proposal we shared on Tuesday. Please let me know if you have any questions or if you'd like to schedule a quick 10-minute call to review the scope. Best regards, [Your Name], Strativa Consulting."

Appendix F: Client Complaint Register

(Refer to Section 15.1 for the Complaint Register template).

Appendix G: Client Satisfaction Questionnaire

END-OF-PROJECT CLIENT SATISFACTION SURVEY

Please rate your experience with Strativa Consulting from 1 (Poor) to 5 (Excellent):

1. Professionalism and responsiveness of our team: [ ] / 5
2. Quality and clarity of deliverables: [ ] / 5
3. Adherence to project timelines: [ ] / 5
4. Overall value delivered to your business: [ ] / 5

Comments / Suggestions: _____

Appendix H: Client Offboarding Checklist

[ ] Final deliverables transferred securely [ ] Final invoice settled [ ] System access revoked [ ] Feedback survey sent [ ] Closure email sent.

Appendix I: Sample Client Project-Completion Email

PROJECT COMPLETION & HANDOVER EMAIL

Subject: Project Completion & Final Handover: AZ Signature Brand Strategy

Dear Sara,

We are pleased to confirm the successful completion of the AZ Signature Brand Strategy project. All final deliverables, guideline documents, and campaign assets have been uploaded to your secure shared folder.

It has been a pleasure partnering with your team. We wish AZ Signature tremendous success in your upcoming retail launch.

Warm regards, [Your Name] | Managing Director, Strativa Consulting